Centennial PS School Council Meeting Minutes

March 30 2022

Attendees:

Heidi Holmes
Chase Jordan
Ekamveer Sokhal
Steve Sherlock
Harish Pawagi
Amy LeRoij
Cindy Desbiens
Julie Turner
Deborah
Julie-Ann
Karen Howey
Laura Cowley
Nima Hashi
Shaymaa Gneed
Andrea Molckovsky

1. Student presentation:
    a. Chase and Ekamveer are Grade 8 students: gaga ball pit idea. The students would like to build a gaga ball pit in the yard. A gaga ball pit is an enclosed hexagonal area, wherein 10 students and a ball play a version of dodgeball. The cost to build this hexagonal structure is about $2350 + HST, as quoted by Fred's Fencing who is an approved vendor with the Board. There are 8 schools ahead of us in line for spring construction. Students would like to run an outdoor carnival in April to raise money for the gaga ball pit. They already have some donations of gift cards as prizes during the carnival. Plan is to give each student one ticket for free, then additional tickets are 1 dollar each. Therefore each student needs to spend 3 dollars.
    b. The gaga ball pit floor would consist of woodchips – the school board would replace this ground cover every year. The gaga ball pit can be used in the winter. The spot for the pit is not yet picked – likely near the edge of the field so other games such as soccer are not affected.
2. Principal's and teachers' report:
    a. Looking forward to plans for September at this time.
    b. Most students seem very happy to see the lifting of covid restrictions, particularly the cohort grouping.
    c. Extracurricular activites have resumed now.
    d. Guidance counsellor is busy with grade 8 students and their choice of high schools.
    e. They have initiated communication with feeder schools as well, i.e. orientation in person.
    f. They are planning a school wide assembly.
    g. Possible pizza day in the near future.
    h. Track and field will resume this spring as well, with a possible track day in Cambridge.

They are booking buses as they confirm dates.

i. Parents and families might be allowed in the school again for an open house and for grade 8 year end celebration.

j. Sound system is planned but not yet installed, hopefully by May/June in time for graduation celebration.

k. They will resume emergency procedures drills, such as a tornado drill planned for Monday.

l. They will not be allowing kids to use lockers, many grade 8 students are out in portables, and there isn't enough time in transition to access the lockers anyways, and they don't need them really.

3. Report from the WRAPSC meeting:
    a. Destreaming of math – started this current year in grade 9. Other subjects will also be destreamed starting next year in Gr 9. Also grade 10 math is being destreamed as of 2022/23. Slides are available from Heidi.
    b. A new board-wide dress code policy should be implemented from K-12 for 2022-23; ongoing consulatations with families and students.
    c. Next meeting is April 5th
    d. Last meeting with be in person in May, possibly at the Ardelt location, with a presentation from the trustees regarding their roles etc.
4. Treasurer's report
    a. No change to the amount of funds available (approximately 4K right now). b. Motion regarding supporting the gaga ball pit idea as presented by Heidi: i. We will use student council funds to fund the gaga ball pit. We will tell the students that we will match the funds that they raise, hoping the students will be able to raise about half of the amount. Furthermore we will cover any deficit to meet the total obligation, upon secondary review after the carnival, in a

manner that does not delay the construction of the gaga ball pit.

ii. Motion was seconded by Harish. Motion was carried by majority vote.

5. Fundraising ideas, spending in future:
    a. Grade 8 year end celebration – usually has not requiring extra funds from council, considered zero cost. Perhaps there could be some support for a more in person celebration, perhaps funds for food. However it is complicated because of the large number of kids graduating (200), in the past this necessitated a ceremony at Center in The Square.
    b. Field trips – sometimes in the past was subsidized by student council. No firm plans have been set for any field trips this coming spring.
    c. Consider re-instituting pizza day next fall, historically has been a great way to raise money, to be discussed further at next meeting
    d. Teacher appreciation day in May
6. Items for next school council agenda:
    a. Pizza day (or similar) fundraising for fall
    b. How to spend money for staff appreciation day in May
    c. Grade 8 graduation ceremony ideas
    d. Any other ideas for the fall
7. Equity work:
    a. How to engage more of our community school members at our school council, especially marginalized groups. Decided to focus on the Muslim population to start

with, given that these parents are underrepresented at our meetings and Muslim students make up a significant portion of our student population.

b. There are listening forums that the board is hosting to try to engage different groups. Heidi was not allowed to attend the Muslim listening group because she is not Muslim. Heidi will be meeting with two representatives from the Women's Muslim Association instead to try and understand some of the barriers and have beginning conversation on how we can reduce these to promote school council engagement.